

UNIVERSITY PARTNERSHIP PROGRAM

The CRE AI Practicum

A university-sponsored build program where real estate students stop studying AI — and start building with it.

12

WEEKS, ALIGNED
TO THE
SEMESTER

6

SHIPPED AI
ARTIFACTS PER
STUDENT

1

VERIFIED "AI FOR
CRE"
CERTIFICATION

\$0

COST TO
STUDENTS —
SCHOOL-
SPONSORED

STUDIO MEMBERS REPRESENT

CBRE · NEWMARK · METLIFE · COLLIERS · CUSHMAN & WAKEFIELD · AVISON YOUNG · SAVILLS ·
COMPASS

The one-page summary

What it is. A semester-aligned, 12-week hands-on build program that runs alongside a university's existing real estate curriculum. Students don't study AI — they build with it, every week, on real deal documents, with the same tools and community used by working professionals at the industry's biggest firms. The program culminates in the **CRE AI Studio "AI for CRE" Certification** — a two-part exam (knowledge test + screen-recorded agent build) that students add directly to LinkedIn.

Who pays. The university — never the student. The Practicum is licensed by the school as a program benefit, the way schools sponsor Bloomberg terminal access, ARGUS training, or CFA prep. Students get it free with their enrollment.

What it is not. It is not a course, and it does not compete with one. A university's CRE AI course teaches students *about* artificial intelligence in real estate — the concepts, the landscape, the implications. The Practicum is the lab layer underneath it: the place where students put hands on the tools, ship working artifacts, and leave with a portfolio and a credential. The two are designed to stack.

Why schools sponsor it: "Our students graduate AI-certified, with a portfolio of working AI tools they built themselves" is a recruiting and placement story no lecture can produce — delivered with zero faculty lift, zero admin burden, and semester-end reporting on engagement and certification pass rates.

*Program name alternatives under consideration: **The CRE AI Practicum** (used throughout) · The Student Studio · CRE AI Lab: Campus Edition.*

1 The gap this fills

Real estate programs have moved fast on AI. Many — including the best ones — now offer a CRE AI course. Those courses do what courses do well: frameworks, case studies, critical thinking about where the industry is going.

But there are four things a semester course structurally cannot do, no matter how good the professor:

1 · Stay current

Syllabi are locked months in advance; the AI toolscape changes weekly. Practicum content is produced continuously by a team whose full-time job is teaching AI to CRE professionals — including a weekly "AI This Week in CRE" briefing.

2 · Give every student reps

One build lab per week, every week. Each student personally builds rent roll analyzers, lease abstraction workflows, underwriting copilots, and autonomous agents. Skills come from reps, not slides.

3 · Put students in the room

Students join the private community where hundreds of working CRE professionals — brokers, asset managers, analysts, attorneys — share what's working. A semester of ambient mentorship, not a guest-speaker cameo.

4 · Issue a verifiable credential

A grade says a student passed a course. The certification says they built a working CRE AI agent on camera, from a cold brief — and it lives on their LinkedIn under Licenses & Certifications.

The result: **the classroom teaches judgment, the Practicum builds capability.** Schools shouldn't have to pick — and with this model, they don't.

2 Classroom vs. Practicum — designed to stack

	The university's CRE AI course	The CRE AI Practicum
Teaches	Concepts, landscape, implications	Tools, workflows, building
Format	Lectures, readings, cases	Weekly live build labs + async lessons
Materials	Fixed at semester start	Updated continuously; weekly AI briefings
Output	Papers, exams, a grade	Working AI tools, a portfolio, a certification
Taught by	Faculty	Operators who train CRE professionals full-time
Network	Classmates	Hundreds of working CRE professionals
Cost to student	Tuition	\$0 — sponsored by the school

Faculty stay in control: the Practicum maps to the academic calendar, with full curriculum visibility and cohort progress reporting — and tighter integrations are built with any professor who wants them.

3 Program structure — the 12-week arc

One semester. Three phases. Every week: one live build session (recorded, posted within 24 hours), async step-by-step video lessons, open office hours, a community build challenge, and the "AI This Week in CRE" briefing.

PHASE 1 • WEEKS 1–3

Foundations in Practice

Goal: every student leaves week 3 with a personal AI workspace and real fluency in the core tools.

- WEEK 1** **Your AI Workspace.** Set up and configure ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini; how large language models actually behave (and fail); first working session analyzing a real offering memorandum.
- WEEK 2** **Prompting for CRE.** Prompt patterns that matter in practice; the CRE Prompt Library; hands-on document analysis of rent rolls and leases.
- WEEK 3** **AI-Powered Research.** Market research and comp gathering with AI; verification habits and hallucination control — the professional discipline of trusting-but-checking model output.

PHASE 2 • WEEKS 4–9

Build Labs

Goal: six weeks, six shipped artifacts. Every lab produces something a student can show a recruiter.

- WEEK 4** **Rent Roll & T12 Analysis Lab.** Turn messy property financials into clean analysis: occupancy, loss-to-lease, expense anomalies.
- WEEK 5** **Lease Abstraction Lab.** Build a repeatable AI workflow that abstracts commercial leases into structured summaries.
- WEEK 6** **Market Research Agent Lab.** Build an agent that gathers, synthesizes, and cites market data for a submarket.
- WEEK 7** **Underwriting Copilot Lab.** From offering memorandum to draft investment memo: assumptions, returns framing, risks.
- WEEK 8** **Automation Lab.** Connect AI to real workflows with Zapier / Make / n8n — intake, extraction, notification pipelines.
- WEEK 9** **Pitch & Content Lab.** AI-generated decks and polished deliverables: turn the week-7 memo into a presentation-grade pitch.

Certification

Goal: convert a semester of building into a verified, LinkedIn-ready credential.

- WEEK 10 Agent Build Review.** Students rebuild and harden their strongest agent; mock practical against a sample brief.
- WEEK 11 Exam Prep.** Structured review of the full curriculum; timed practice exam; dedicated office hours.
- WEEK 12 Certification Window.** Students sit the two-part AI for CRE Certification exam (below).

4 The "AI for CRE" Certification

The credential is the spine of the program — the thing a student walks away with that a course grade can't replicate.

Part 1 — Knowledge exam

Multiple choice, covering the full applied curriculum: LLM behavior and limitations, CRE prompting, document analysis, research verification, automation architecture, and agent design. Timed, online, closed-book.

Part 2 — Practical exam

The differentiator. Each student receives a cold brief (e.g., "build an agent that abstracts this lease and flags non-standard clauses") and **screen-records themselves building a working CRE AI agent** against it. Graded on a published rubric: does it work, is the approach sound, does the student demonstrate command of the tools — not just the ability to follow along.

Passing both parts earns the CRE AI Studio "AI for CRE" Certification:

- A verified credential added to LinkedIn under **Licenses & Certifications**, issued by CRE AI Studio
- A shareable certificate (co-brandable with the sponsoring university)
- Listing in the Studio's certified-student directory that hiring member firms can browse

Retake policy. One included retake per part. Students who don't pass by semester end can complete certification in a following exam window.

Why it lands with recruiters. Every resume this decade will say "familiar with AI tools." A screen-recorded, rubric-graded build is proof, not a claim. That's the difference between listing a skill and demonstrating one — and it's a story the school gets to tell about its graduates.

5 What makes it feel nothing like class

Portfolio over grades

Six shipped artifacts plus a certified agent build.
Every week ends with something real.

A real credential

The certification goes on LinkedIn; a problem set doesn't.

The industry is in the room

Students join the working-professional community from day one. Mentor matching connects them with member professionals in the lane they want — brokerage, asset management, development, legal.

Taught by operators

The instructors run an AI training company for CRE professionals — the same lessons top CRE teams pay for, tuned for students.

Career edge, explicitly. The final weeks include positioning help: how to present the certification and portfolio on a resume, in interviews, and on LinkedIn as "the analyst who can actually build with AI."

6 The sponsorship model

Students never pay. The university licenses the Practicum the way it licenses ARGUS training or Bloomberg terminals — as infrastructure for student outcomes. Three ways in (*pricing illustrative and open to structuring*):

	Pilot Cohort	Department License	Campus License
Shape	One semester, capped seats	Per-seat, per semester	Annual, program-wide
Seats	Up to 50 students	25+ seats	All enrolled RE students
Pricing	Flat fee (~\$7,500)	~\$125–150 / student / semester, volume-tiered	Annual flat license, custom
Includes	Full program + certification	Pilot + faculty reporting dashboard + one guest lecture per semester	Department + co-branded certification + curriculum previews + standing faculty access
Best for	Proving it out this semester	A single graduate or undergrad program	Schools making AI fluency a program-wide differentiator

Every tier includes, for the school:

Zero lift

Studio runs everything — onboarding, sessions, community, office hours, exams, credentialing.

Semester-end reporting

Enrollment, engagement, completion, and certification pass rates for the school's cohort.

Faculty access

Instructors see the full curriculum and materials, and can sit in on any session.

A marketing story

"Our students graduate AI-certified" — usable in program marketing, rankings narratives, and employer conversations.

The pipeline logic (why this is sustainable for Studio): certified students graduate into the industry already fluent in the Studio ecosystem, and convert to professional membership at an alumni rate — so the sponsored price stays far below retail while the program stays first-class.

7 Outcomes & success metrics

What we report to the sponsoring school each semester, and what "working" looks like:

Metric	Definition	Target
Completion rate	Share of enrolled students active through week 12	70%+
Certification pass rate	First-sit / final	60%+ / 80%+
Artifacts shipped	Average build-lab artifacts completed per student	5 of 6
Placement signal	Certified students reporting the credential surfaced in interviews (exit survey)	Tracked
Student NPS	End-of-semester survey	50+

8 Pilot proposal template

Proposed: [University] × CRE AI Studio Pilot Cohort — [Spring/Fall 20XX]

- **Cohort:** up to 50 students from [program], nominated by faculty or open-enrolled with program approval
- **Term:** 12 weeks, aligned to the academic calendar; live sessions scheduled around core course blocks
- **Cost to students:** \$0 — fully sponsored by [University / department / a named industry sponsor]
- **Cost to sponsor:** flat pilot fee of \$[X] for the semester, all-inclusive (program, community, certification exams, reporting)
- **Faculty involvement:** full curriculum visibility; optional co-taught session; semester-end review with engagement and certification data
- **Success criteria (agreed up front):** ≥70% completion, ≥60% certification pass, student NPS ≥50 — hit them, and both sides have the case for a Department License
- **Timeline:** agreement by [date] → student onboarding week of [date] → kickoff [date]

An industry-sponsor variant is available: a brokerage or owner-operator underwrites the cohort in exchange for early access to certified students — relevant where department budget is the constraint.

CRE AI Studio — the premier AI training platform for commercial real estate professionals. Founded by Jonathan Buckelew, Nadine Ezzie, and Topher Stephenson. Members represent CBRE, Newmark, MetLife, Avison Young, Colliers, Beacon Capital, Cushman & Wakefield, Savills, and Compass, among others.